

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The patient has a long history of sadness and feels his life is cursed , indicating a chronic depressive state .
- He has worsening suicidal ideations , which is a significant symptom of depression .
- He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless , both common symptoms of depression .
- He also has recent symptoms of worsening depression such as energy and concentration issues , which suggests a possible worsening of his condition .
- He is able to hold a job and get enough sleep , which rules out severe depression .
- He does not show symptoms of mania or psychosis , nor does he have a personality disorder .
- The patient's long history of depression and recent worsening of symptoms , along with the presence of hopelessness and suicidal ideations , suggests a possible diagnosis of double depression , which is a combination of chronic depression and a major depressive episode .

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<answer>A . The patient is at risk for double depression.</answer>